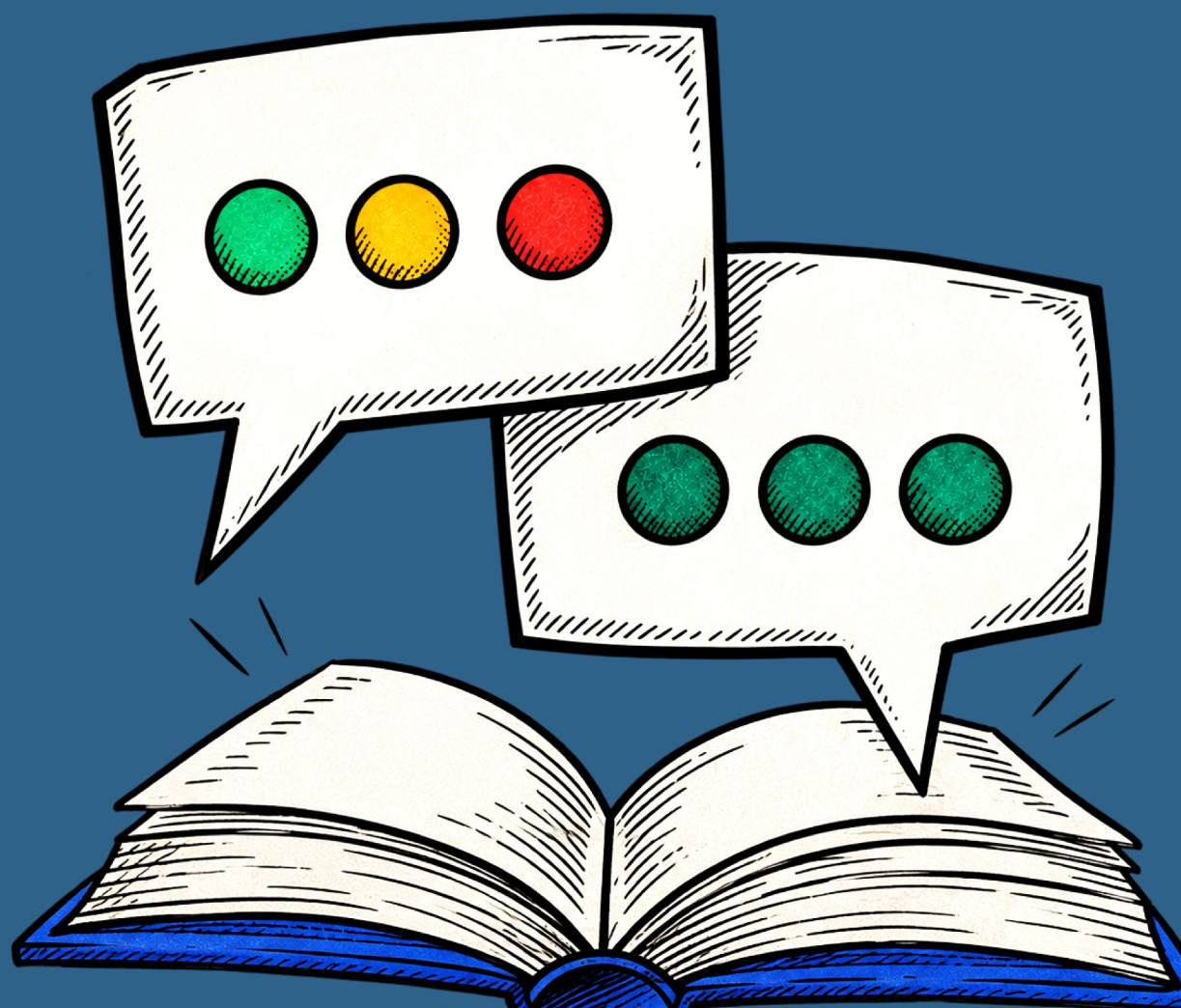


EDUCATION SCALABILITY CONVERSATIONS

**A guide to having conversations
that help you scale.**





WELCOME

If you're reading this, it's likely that you are building or implementing something that gives children access to quality education.

We believe locally-led, effective education initiatives already exist — you're probably working on one right now! The more pressing challenge is scaling them up to different contexts, while sustaining the shifts in practice, policy and structures they require. This tool helps you tackle that challenge.

Underpinning this tool is the belief that conversations matter. They build shared understanding, give new ideas or insights, and can spark tangible action.

In this tool, you will see seven modules. Each one contains a facilitator's guide to running one focused conversation, around a specific scaling topic. This includes guidance on why it matters, who to include, key guiding questions and prompts, an example to learn from, and ideas for next steps.

Each module should take roughly two hours, from planning, to running the conversation itself, to reflecting on next steps. **You don't need to do everything at once — we have some tips below on which module is most relevant for where you are now.**

Before you dive in, we recommend you read the [facilitator guidelines \(on pg.3\)](#). These give valuable context on how to make the most of the modules.

THIS TOOL WAS DEVELOPED BY

This tool was developed by Enabel, in collaboration with VVOB and Brink. It is an updated version of the Education Scalability Checklist, a tool originally created by VVOB in collaboration with Brookings Center for Universal Education, Educate!, Management Systems International (MSI), Pratham, and STiR Education.



INSTRUCTIONS FOR USING THE TOOL:

6 SIMPLE STEPS

1

Pick a module.

Each module focuses on a core category for scalability — you can find the full list on [page 4](#). On [page 5](#), we have further guidance on how to choose the right conversation, based on your scaling stage.

2

Bring together the suggested stakeholders

for a 30-90 minute meeting (in person or a call), or leverage time you already have. Below, we have recommendations on who to convene for each module.

3

Discussing the core question

Start your time together by discussing the core question. You can find this at the top of the module.

4

Then, use the further prompts to guide your discussion.

Together, we hope that this furthers your understanding of the initiative's scalability within this particular category, unlock new insights and ideas,

5

Capture whether you feel confident, unsure, or worried about it.

After the conversation, take 30 mins to work through the list of prompts and capture whether you feel confident, unsure, or worried about it. Based on this, give the module an overall rating.

6

Agree the next steps.

We provide some ideas and examples on how other initiatives have improved their scalability in this category.

MODULES



What is the initiative and why does it matter?



How will it scale?



What is the evidence of positive impact?



How strong is support for the initiative, and the change it entails?



What is the cost, and is there funding to cover it?



Is the initiative designed for ease of transfer?



Is your organization set up to scale the initiative?

EACH MODULE IS A SEPARATE CONVERSATION. CHOOSE WHICHEVER ONE FEELS MOST RELEVANT.

NOTES ON WHEN TO FOCUS ON SPECIFIC CONVERSATIONS

It's impossible to focus on everything from the start. At the same time, we believe different moments in the scaling journey trigger different conversations.

That's why we've tagged each module with a point in the scaling journey. In our experience, this is the stage from which the conversation usually becomes important. We've aligned these to the **six scaling stages set out by the International Development Innovation Alliance (IDIA)**, a widely used framework. The four stages we focus on are:



Ideation

Defining and analysing the development problem and generating potential solutions through horizon scanning of existing and new ideas.



Research and Development (R&D)

Further developing specific innovations that have potential to address the problem.



Proof of Concept

When the intellectual concept behind an innovation is field-tested to gain an early, 'real-world' assessment of its potential.



Transition to Scale

When innovations that have demonstrated small-scale success develop their model and attract partners to help fill gaps in their capacity to scale.

NOTE

A module doesn't stop being relevant as you move on. It stays live, and we encourage you to return to modules as your initiative scales. For example, we recommend you begin conversations on evidence of impact from the R&D phase, but deepen them as you move through subsequent stages.

NOTES ON WHO TO INCLUDE IN SPECIFIC CONVERSATIONS

This tool is targeted at a core facilitator(s), who convenes and runs each conversation. Beyond that, not all stakeholders belong in every conversation.

We've also tagged each module with the people we believe matter most — either because they can bring important insights and ideas, or aligning them is crucial, or they will play a role in follow-on actions. Getting people into these strategic conversations early builds ownership, and getting the right people focuses efforts and minds. Our experience teaches us that this is critical to scaling any initiative.

Here's the full list of stakeholders. You'll engage different groups at different points:



Inside your organisation

- Organisational Leadership (internal)
- Frontline / Field Staff (internal)
- Finance & Budget holders (internal)
- M&E or Research Team (internal)



Government & the Education Systems

- National policymakers
- Local Education Officers
- School Leaders
- Teachers & Educators



Wider Allies

- Learners' Caregivers & Communities
- Funders & Donors
- Coalition Partners & Influential Allies

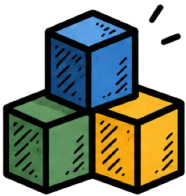


FACILITATOR TIPS: 5 WAYS TO GET THE MOST OUT OF YOUR EDUCATION SCALABILITY CONVERSATIONS



Have ~3 scalability conversations per year

This equals about one day of work for the lead facilitator, per year — an investment we believe is very worthwhile to help make sure your initiative has the best possible chances of scaling, and course correct. A rhythm of roughly three scalability conversations keeps scalability a live question within your organisation and its partners.



Revisit the modules as you scale

These modules are not “one and done”. Revisit earlier modules as you talk to different stakeholders and as you grow, particularly where your confidence is low.



Use what's already in your calendar

Scalability can be folded into existing touchpoints: monitoring visits to schools, review meetings with funders, or update calls with local or national government officials. You can do this by taking the core question and a smaller number of the prompts in each module, and embedding them into the existing conversations.



Practice generative listening

Generative listening is a deep form of listening where you listen for new possibilities that you didn't expect or think about prior to the conversation. It involves slowing down, listening to the words, images and emotions chosen, suspending judgement, and noticing what you don't understand. You can learn more about generative listening in this

[5 minute read.](#)



Close the loop right away

After the conversation, capture the key points you heard and at least one concrete next step. We provide a basic template for this in each module, with examples and ideas. Capturing this quickly helps make sure the discussion turns to action, and that knowledge on scalability is codified and builds up over time.

EACH MODULE IN A NUTSHELL

Module	Use this from... (see page 6 for more details)	Use this with... (see page 7 for more details)	Print Pages
What is the initiative and why does it matter?	Ideation	Organization Leadership (Internal) Frontline/Field Staff(Internal) Teachers & Educators Learners' Caregivers And The Wider Community	
How will you <u>Scale</u>?	Ideation	Organisational Leadership (Internal) Coalition Partners & Influential Allies National Policymakers (Optional) Local Education Officers (Optional) Funders & Donors (Optional)	
What is the evidence of positive <u>impact</u>?	Research and Development	M&E Or Research Team (Internal) Frontline / Field Staff (Internal) Local Education Officers National Policymakers Funders & Donors	
How strong is <u>support</u> for the initiative, and the change it entails?	Research and Development Proof of Concept	Frontline / Field Staff (Internal) M&E Or Research Team (Internal) National Policymakers (Optional) Local Education Officers (Optional) School Leaders (Optional) Teachers & Educators (Optional)	
What is the <u>cost</u>, and is there <u>funding</u> to cover it?	Research and Development Proof of Concept	Organisational Leadership (Internal) Finance & Budget Holders (Internal) National Policymakers Local Education Officers Funders & Donors	
Is the initiative designed for ease of <u>transfer</u>?	Proof of Concept Transition to Scale	Frontline / Field Staff (Internal) M&E Or Research Team (Internal) Teachers & Educators School Leaders Local Education Officers	
Is your <u>organization</u> set up to scale the initiative?	Proof of Concept Transition to Scale	Organisational Leadership (Internal)	



WHAT IS THE INITIATIVE, AND WHY DOES IT MATTER?

USE THIS FROM

Ideation

USE THIS WITH

Organization leadership (internal)

Frontline/field staff(internal)

Teacher & educators

Learners' caregivers and the wider community

START YOUR CONVERSATION WITH THIS QUESTION

What's the problem we're trying to solve, and do we all agree exactly how we're solving it?

PROMPTS FOR FURTHER DISCUSSION

(Use these prompts to probe further. When the conversation is over, mark whether you feel confident, unsure, or concerned about the specific prompt. Write down the key evidence for this response and any other key points in the 'evidence' column')

Are we agreed on the problem we're trying to solve?

Most education initiatives are trying to do one of three things: widen access to education, improve quality or relevance, or reduce gaps between groups of learners. Which one comes first for you, and what's the specific problem you're doing within it?

How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**

☐ **UNSURE**

☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)



How big is the problem we're solving?

How long has the problem been there? How many learners or teachers does it affect? The larger and more persistent the problem, the easier it will be to build support around the initiative.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**

☐ **UNSURE**

☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)

Could we all describe our initiative in the same way?

It could be a new curriculum, teaching materials, education technology, or associated pedagogy, a course for in-service teachers or school leaders, the introduction of a new function such as mentor teacher or a new way of holding schools to account, and so on.

Ask everyone to describe the initiative in a couple of sentences, and then compare notes. In particular, compare whether a user (e.g. a teacher) can describe it in the same way as the implementing organisation.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**

☐ **UNSURE**

☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)



Which components of the initiative are essential, which is extra?

The essential parts are the ones that lead to impact, and must travel with the initiative as it scales. Everything else can be flexed to fit a new district.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**

☐ **UNSURE**

☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)



Overall, we feel...

☐ CONFIDENT

☐ UNSURE

☐ CONCERNED

Why? (Write here)

IDEAS FOR TAKING ACTION

If possible, populate this with ~2 ideas for next steps. Ideally, these would be based on real-world actions that education initiatives have taken.

Add Ideas here



HOW WILL YOU SCALE?

USE THIS FROM

Ideation

USE THIS WITH

Organization leadership (internal)

Local Education Officers (Optional)

Coalition Partners & Influential Allies

National Policymakers (Optional)

START YOUR CONVERSATION WITH THIS QUESTION

How well do we understand our route from where we are today, to scale?

PROMPTS FOR FURTHER DISCUSSION

(Use these prompts to probe further. When the conversation is over, mark whether you feel confident, unsure, or concerned about the specific prompt. Write down the key evidence for this response and any other key points in the 'evidence' column')

Who decides on whether the initiative is adopted?

How many decision makers are involved in adopting the initiative at scale? Who are they? The more specific names and decision points you can outline here, the better.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**

☐ **UNSURE**

☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)

**Who exactly is expected to implement the initiative at a scaled-up basis?**

When it comes to delivering public goods such as education sustainably and at scale, government institutions are essential. delivery network, operational capacity, funding base and incentive structure needed to deliver education in perpetuity to large populations.

While governments play an essential role in provision, as well as in setting and regulating standards and norms, there may also be other organisations involved (e.g. private partners, non-profit organisations, associations, etc)

Can you name the doers involved in adopting the initiative at scale? The more specific roles and tasks you can outline here, the better.

How does the group feel about this?☐ **CONFIDENT**☐ **UNSURE**☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)**Which components of our initiatives are intended to scale?**

It's rare for the whole initiative to scale. In our experience, parts are typically dropped or heavily simplified. Answer this based on what you know about the problem and scaling partners — and expect it to change over time.

How does the group feel about this?☐ **CONFIDENT**☐ **UNSURE**☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)

**Who is benefitting at scale?**

Which teachers or learners? In which grades? In which districts? Are you aligned on a clear target group?

How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**☐ **UNSURE**☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)

By when will we scale?

How many of our target group have we reached in 2 years? 5 years? 10 years? In our experience. 15 years from idea to scale is a good estimate.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**☐ **UNSURE**☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)

**How similar are the places we are scaling into to the place we started?**

You might think about geography, language, political structures, culture, income levels, and other factors. Scaling across more diverse contexts is harder — but crucial for educational equity.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**☐ **UNSURE**☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)

What is our role when the initiative is at scale?

Even when the initiative has been transferred, the implementing organisation will still have a role to play. This might involve advocacy, product development, certification, quality control, and so on.

It is easier to plan towards scale when expectations about the future relationship between the originating and adopting organizations have been shared.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**☐ **UNSURE**☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)

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How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**☐ **UNSURE**☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)



Overall, we feel...

☐ CONFIDENT	☐ UNSURE	☐ CONCERNED
Why? (Write here)		

 IDEAS FOR TAKING ACTION

If possible, populate this with ~2 ideas for next steps. Ideally, these would be based on real-world actions that education initiatives have taken.

Add Ideas here



WHAT IS THE EVIDENCE OF IMPACT?

USE THIS FROM

Research & Development

USE THIS WITH

M&E Or Research Team (Internal)

Frontline/field staff(internal)

Local Education Officers

National Policymakers

Funders & Donors

START YOUR CONVERSATION WITH THIS QUESTION

How clear and robust is the evidence that the initiative improves learning, and will keep doing that as we grow into diverse settings?

PROMPTS FOR FURTHER DISCUSSION

(Use these prompts to probe further. When the conversation is over, mark whether you feel confident, unsure, or concerned about the specific prompt. Write down the key evidence for this response and any other key points in the 'evidence' column')

Do we have evidence from another context that we can use, and how similar is the context to the one we're scaling into?

For example, this evidence might be from our initiative in another country, or a similar initiative in the same (or a similar) country.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**

☐ **UNSURE**

☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)



Do we have evidence from the current implementation, and how similar is that to the context we are scaling into?

How does the group feel about this?

☐ CONFIDENT

☐ UNSURE

☐ CONCERNED

Why? (Write here)

Is our evidence rigorous on the outcomes we care about?

For example, is impact attributable to our initiative?

Outcomes might include: improved access, better learning outcomes, or reduced educational inequality between diverse groups.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ CONFIDENT

☐ UNSURE

☐ CONCERNED

Why? (Write here)



Would the people we need to convince count perceive this evidence as robust?

For example, this may be national policymakers or funders.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ CONFIDENT

☐ UNSURE

☐ CONCERNED

Why? (Write here)

Is the impact visible to people who matter?

For example, this may be

How does the group feel about this?

☐ CONFIDENT

☐ UNSURE

☐ CONCERNED

Why? (Write here)

Is there evidence on the initiative that wasn't generated by us (the implementers)?

Independent third-party evidence is typically seen as more credible.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ CONFIDENT

☐ UNSURE

☐ CONCERNED

Why? (Write here)



WHAT IS THE EVIDENCE OF IMPACT?

Overall, we feel...

☐ CONFIDENT

☐ UNSURE

☐ CONCERNED

Why? (Write here)

IDEAS FOR TAKING ACTION

If possible, populate this with ~2 ideas for next steps. Ideally, these would be based on real-world actions that education initiatives have taken.

Add Ideas here



HOW STRONG IS THE SUPPORT FOR THE INITIATIVE, AND THE CHANGE IT ENTAILS?

USE THIS FROM

Research & Development

Proof of Concept

USE THIS WITH

Frontline/field staff(internal)

M&E Or Research Team (Internal)

National Policymakers (Optional)

Teachers & Educators (Optional)

Local Education Officers (Optional)

School Leaders (Optional)

START YOUR CONVERSATION WITH THIS QUESTION

From the classroom to the Ministry, how strongly is the initiative (and change it entails) wanted?

PROMPTS FOR FURTHER DISCUSSION

(Use these prompts to probe further. When the conversation is over, mark whether you feel confident, unsure, or concerned about the specific prompt. Write down the key evidence for this response and any other key points in the 'evidence' column')

Are we addressing a need that is sharply felt by potential target groups?

Do our target groups feel that the problem you're solving is a pressing and urgent priority? Or will it feel like it's your priority, not theirs?

In this instance, target groups means everyone the initiative is aimed at — learners, teachers, school leaders, parents, district officials, etc.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**

☐ **UNSURE**

☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)



HOW STRONG IS THE SUPPORT FOR THE INITIATIVE, AND THE CHANGE IT ENTAILS?

How are our target groups solving the problem today?

There is always a current approach, even if it amounts to coping, working around the problem, or having accepted it as normal. Find out what that approach is and how adequate people believe it to be.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ CONFIDENT

☐ UNSURE

☐ CONCERNED

Why? (Write here)

Are we addressing an issue that is high on the national policy agenda?

Is there demonstrated political will behind solving the problem? This might mean an appearance in a strategy document or ministerial speech. More promisingly, we should see someone spending time, budget or authority on moving it forward, and a willingness to meet resistance when it comes.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ CONFIDENT

☐ UNSURE

☐ CONCERNED

Why? (Write here)



HOW STRONG IS THE SUPPORT FOR THE INITIATIVE, AND THE CHANGE IT ENTAILS?

Is there a strong leadership coalition committed to the change, and expected to stay in place?

To facilitate scaling in education, coalitions for change typically require strong leadership from the government (“political will”) as well as from a range of other stakeholders. On the government side, sustaining political will over a long period of time – across election cycles and regime changes – can be challenging, which points to the importance of building a nonpartisan support base.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ CONFIDENT

☐ UNSURE

☐ CONCERNED

Why? (Write here)

Is the change we are seeking supported by eminent individuals and institutions?

“Eminent” can apply to a range of individuals or institutions, such as high-level government officials (signaling political buy-in and will), influential think tanks, media attractive supporters (e.g., celebrity ambassadors), etc

How does the group feel about this?

☐ CONFIDENT

☐ UNSURE

☐ CONCERNED

Why? (Write here)



HOW STRONG IS THE SUPPORT FOR THE INITIATIVE, AND THE CHANGE IT ENTAILS?

Is there demonstrable support for the initiative among educators and key staff in the education system?

“Educators” refers to teachers and school leaders. These groups are called out explicitly, because they play a dominant role in whether an initiative succeeds or fails while too often, they are not included in decision-making about implementation. Too often, teachers and school leaders are “handed” the initiative, on the assumption that they are or should be in support.

“Key staff” refers to all those involved in taking the initiative to scale and implementing it at scale -- i.e., system leaders at the level of districts / zones / provinces / ..., teacher trainers, etc. Lack of support or active resistance from well-organized key staff will create challenges for scaling.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**

☐ **UNSURE**

☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)



HOW STRONG IS THE SUPPORT FOR THE INITIATIVE, AND THE CHANGE IT ENTAILS?

Overall, we feel...

☐ CONFIDENT

☐ UNSURE

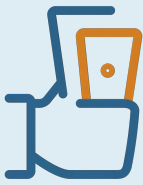
☐ CONCERNED

Why? (Write here)

IDEAS FOR TAKING ACTION

If possible, populate this with ~2 ideas for next steps. Ideally, these would be based on real-world actions that education initiatives have taken.

Add Ideas here



WHAT IS THE COST, AND IS THERE FUNDING TO COVER IT?

USE THIS FROM

Research & Development

Proof of Concept

USE THIS WITH

Organisational Leadership (Internal)

Local Education Officers

National Policymakers

Finance & Budget Holders (Internal)

Funders & Donors

@START YOUR CONVERSATION WITH THIS QUESTION

Do we know what this costs at scale — and is there a realistic route to it being paid for without us?

💬 PROMPTS FOR FURTHER DISCUSSION

(Use these prompts to probe further. When the conversation is over, mark whether you feel confident, unsure, or concerned about the specific prompt. Write down the key evidence for this response and any other key points in the 'evidence' column')

Do you know what the cost is per learner (or per teacher, or per school), per year?

This is different to the cost of your project. Once the initiative is running, what is the ongoing cost per year? Depending on your initiative, segment this by learner, by teacher, or by school. Separate the one-off costs of setting it up from the recurring cost of keeping it going.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**

☐ **UNSURE**

☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)



Are the budget implications clear, predictable and justifiable to those who are expected to bear the costs?

Whoever ends up bearing the cost — likely to include government agencies at national or local level — need to be able to see it, predict it, and justify it. Does our initiative allow for this?

How does the group feel about this?

☐ CONFIDENT

☐ UNSURE

☐ CONCERNED

Why? (Write here)

How does the cost compare to what is being spent today?

This does not imply that cheaper solutions and models are necessarily better. Achieving educational equity typically has a price, for instance. Simply, it refers to the fact that initiatives that place less burden on budgets that are typically already overstretched, are easier to scale

How does the group feel about this?

☐ CONFIDENT

☐ UNSURE

☐ CONCERNED

Why? (Write here)



What will it take to reach scale, and how do we mobilise it?

This might include funding for developing the product, building systems, initial training, and so on. It is usually a sharper payment than ongoing running costs, and falls more significantly on funders rather than governments.

Understand what this initial funding might need to be, and honestly whether the amount is one you could raise.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ CONFIDENT

☐ UNSURE

☐ CONCERNED

Why? (Write here)

Can the cost of implementation at scale be integrated in the government budget?

Is there a budget line this could sit within, and is it plausible that money would actually be allocated to it?

Funding that fits inside the existing budget structure is far easier to secure than funding that requires a new line to be created.

Where non-state organisations will keep delivering part of the initiative, ask where their share comes from once your funding ends?

How does the group feel about this?

☐ CONFIDENT

☐ UNSURE

☐ CONCERNED

Why? (Write here)



WHAT IS THE COST, AND IS THERE FUNDING TO COVER IT?

Overall, we feel...

☐ CONFIDENT

☐ UNSURE

☐ CONCERNED

Why? (Write here)

IDEAS FOR TAKING ACTION

If possible, populate this with ~2 ideas for next steps. Ideally, these would be based on real-world actions that education initiatives have taken.

Add Ideas here



IS THE INITIATIVE DESIGNED FOR EASE OF TRANSFER, PARTICULARLY BY ADOPTING GOVERNMENT INSTITUTIONS?

USE THIS FROM

Proof of Concept

Transition to Scale

USE THIS WITH

Frontline / Field Staff (Internal)

Teachers & Educators

M&E Or Research Team (Internal)

School Leaders

Local Education Officers

START YOUR CONVERSATION WITH THIS QUESTION

How good is the fit between the initiative, and the organisations that would run it at scale?

PROMPTS FOR FURTHER DISCUSSION

(Use these prompts to probe further. When the conversation is over, mark whether you feel confident, unsure, or concerned about the specific prompt. Write down the key evidence for this response and any other key points in the 'evidence' column')

Can it be implemented with the people, skills, and infrastructure already present?

What are you assuming exists already: this might be devices or connectivity, transport, physical space, personnel, and so on. Anything not there must be created, funded and maintained — scaling is easier when the initiative is implementable with resources already present in the education system.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**

☐ **UNSURE**

☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)



IS THE INITIATIVE DESIGNED FOR EASE OF TRANSFER, PARTICULARLY BY ADOPTING GOVERNMENT INSTITUTIONS?

How big a change is this for educators and key staff?

Ideally, the initiative would only be a small departure from the current practices of educators and key staff in the education system.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**

☐ **UNSURE**

☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)

Does it fit with existing policy, regulations and structures?

Think of whether or not the initiative is in line with the existing school calendar and school hours; the official curriculum; existing mandates and levels of autonomy of those expected to implement the initiative, their function descriptions and the professional standards they are expected to live up to; etc.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**

☐ **UNSURE**

☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)



IS THE INITIATIVE DESIGNED FOR EASE OF TRANSFER, PARTICULARLY BY ADOPTING GOVERNMENT INSTITUTIONS?

Could someone else pick this up and run it?

Ideally, the initiative shows low complexity and few components, and can be easily added onto the education system.

Any roles, processes, tools and expected outputs should be described and documented clearly, so those who did build it can deliver it.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ CONFIDENT

☐ UNSURE

☐ CONCERNED

Why? (Write here)

Can the system tell whether it is being done well?

Uptake and quality of implementation should be easy to monitor, so supervisors (inspectors, district officials, etc.) can see whether the initiative is being implemented as intended.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ CONFIDENT

☐ UNSURE

☐ CONCERNED

Why? (Write here)



IS THE INITIATIVE DESIGNED FOR EASE OF TRANSFER, PARTICULARLY BY ADOPTING GOVERNMENT INSTITUTIONS?

How strong are the relationships between us and the organisations that would take this on?

Strong collaborative relationships should exist between originating, intermediary and adopting organizations. The originating organization is the organization that develops and pilots the initiative.

The “intermediary organization” is an organization specifically charged with facilitating the scaling up process.

The “adopting organization” is the organization that takes up the initiative after it has been developed and piloted by the originating organization. In education, this is typically the government (alongside other actors).

How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**

☐ **UNSURE**

☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)

Does the initiative fit how adopting organisations actually work?

Look at incentives, norms, accountability structures, and how much discretion people are given. Does our initiative fit within that?

How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**

☐ **UNSURE**

☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)



IS THE INITIATIVE DESIGNED FOR EASE OF TRANSFER, PARTICULARLY BY ADOPTING GOVERNMENT INSTITUTIONS?

Do the adopting organisations have the capacity, reach and experience to run this at scale?

Capacity: Do they have the systems, staff and budget to deliver this across the whole territory, not only where you have been working?

Reach: Do they have real presence and credibility in the places the initiative needs to land?

Experience: Have they taken something like this to scale before, or would this be the first time?

How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**

☐ **UNSURE**

☐ **CONCERNED**

Evidence (you can write here or use post-it notes)



IS THE INITIATIVE DESIGNED FOR EASE OF TRANSFER,
PARTICULARLY BY ADOPTING GOVERNMENT INSTITUTIONS?

Overall, we feel...

☐ CONFIDENT	☐ UNSURE	☐ CONCERNED
Why? (Write here)		

💡 IDEAS FOR TAKING ACTION

If possible, populate this with ~2 ideas for next steps. Ideally, these would be based on real-world actions that education initiatives have taken.

Add Ideas here



IS YOUR ORGANISATION SET UP TO SCALE THE INITIATIVE?

USE THIS FROM

Proof of Concept

Transition to Scale

USE THIS WITH

Organisational Leadership (Internal)

🎯 START YOUR CONVERSATION WITH THIS QUESTION

Does our organisation have the time, skills, and commitment to see the journey through from beginning to end?

💬 PROMPTS FOR FURTHER DISCUSSION

(Use these prompts to probe further. When the conversation is over, mark whether you feel confident, unsure, or concerned about the specific prompt. Write down the key evidence for this response and any other key points in the 'evidence' column')

Do we have the skills and capacity to build, test, and validate this initiative?

This is about developing the initiative itself: designing it, trying it out in the real world, finding out honestly whether it works, and improving it on the evidence. It calls for specific skills: a deep understanding of the user and education system, developing a Theory of Change and measuring impact, and so on.

Do you have the people, with the time and skills, to do this work?

How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**

☐ **UNSURE**

☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)



Do we have the skills and capacity for transferring this initiative?

Handing over the initiative relies on a different set of skills to running it. For example, advocacy and policy engagement, convening partners, documenting the processes, and so on.

As above, do you have the people, with the time and skills, to do this work?

How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**

☐ **UNSURE**

☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)

Do we have the financial resilience to see the initiative from idea to transfer?

15 years from pilot to national scale is a fair estimate in education. Do you believe your organisation can remain financially resilient to do this work, over that time?

While you may not be able to see your finding that far ahead, think honestly about where your funding comes from, and how much rests within a single donor. How might you diversify your income to build resilience?

How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**

☐ **UNSURE**

☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)



Are we committed — including at senior leadership — to prioritising and transferring the initiative?

Has the leadership invested in a team with the time and skills to prioritise this initiative. And, just as importantly, are they committed to the costs of transfer as the initiative moves from idea, to transfer, to handover? This may include a change in roles and funding.

How does the group feel about this?

☐ **CONFIDENT**

☐ **UNSURE**

☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)



IS YOUR ORGANISATION SET UP TO SCALE THE INITIATIVE?

Overall, we feel...

☐ **CONFIDENT**

☐ **UNSURE**

☐ **CONCERNED**

Why? (Write here)

IDEAS FOR TAKING ACTION

If possible, populate this with ~2 ideas for next steps. Ideally, these would be based on real-world actions that education initiatives have taken.

Add Ideas here